COMP396 Final Report Feedback Form

Team number: 2	**Assessor name: Andrew Roxburgh**

A. Summative Assessment

Grade awarded (A++ to F): A	**Signature: Andrew Roxburgh**

Specific Assessment Criteria:

The grade above is based on a profile formed from the following categories. The overall grade awarded is guided by this profile but not necessarily a weighted or averaged grade.

		A++	A+	A	B	C	D	E	F
Research & development	Strategy design			x					
	Optimization/ robustness testing			x					
	Justification of strategy submission			x					
	Analysis for part 3 data			x					
	Conclusions			x					
Report	Structure			x					
	Coverage/level of detail			x					
	Clarity and coherence			x					
Code	Programming style			x					
	Code testing			x					
	Documentation		x						

Justification of grade:

The report is strong overall. It presents a clear multi-component portfolio, with clear choices about which strategies are used on each series, how trades are entered and exited, how capital is allocated, and how positions are sized. The Part 3 analysis is also very good. The report compares expectations with the final results well, explains performance at both asset and strategy level, and gives a sensible discussion of the drop in PD Ratio. There are also good reflections on regime drift, static classification, mean-reversion performance, dynamic allocation, volatility adaptation and trend filters.

The optimisation and robustness testing are substantial and well documented. The report includes grid search, train/test splitting, rolling-window analysis, allocation sensitivity and component testing. This section would have been stronger with a clearer comparison between the optimiser's preferred strategies and the final versions that were actually submitted. It also looks as though some Part 2 validation results were used to make later strategy adjustments, so these results are useful but not a completely independent final check. Some of the robustness checks also needed a clearer explanation of what extra insight they provided beyond the equity curve and component-level results.

The justification for the submitted strategy is convincing, especially where the report explains why simpler or more robust variants were chosen instead of just selecting the most highly optimised versions. Overall, this is a well-structured, detailed and coherent report. There are a few places where the argument could have been tightened, but the report includes an appropriate short reference list and a well-organised, well-explained source code/R&D package. Great stuff.

COMP396 Final Report Feedback Form

Team number: 2	Assessor name: John Fearnley

A. Summative Assessment

Grade awarded (A++ to F): A	Signature: John Fearnley

Specific Assessment Criteria:

The grade above is based on a profile formed from the following categories. The overall grade awarded is guided by this profile but not necessarily a weighted or averaged grade.

		A++	A+	A	B	C	D	E	F
Research & development	Strategy design			x					
	Optimization/ robustness testing			x					
	Justification of strategy submission			x					
	Analysis for part 3 data			x					
	Conclusions			x					
Report	Structure			x					
	Coverage/level of detail			x					
	Clarity and coherence			x					
Code	Programming style			x					
	Code testing			x					
	Documentation			x					

Justification of grade:

- You generally give a clear explanation of the final strategy that you submitted, along with clear entry and exit conditions. So the specification of your strategy is fine.
- Your "Composite Score" formula in Page 5 appears to show that you're scoring the outcomes of your optimization mostly on the test set? This is not how you do a proper optimization: the test set is for final evaluation only, and should not be optimized over. You are very likely to over-fit with this approach. Also, no justification is given for this use of this formula.
- You do clearly show exactly how you carried out your parameter optimization, though, which is good.
- I'm not sure why you're presenting the results in 1.5.2: Yes, the returns of two series is a convex combination of their weights.
- I don't see what the rolling window test tells us that the overall equity curve would not. If you had done a walk-forward test over these windows that would have been useful.
- Likewise, the material in 1.5.4 doesn't really tell us anything that the individual equity curves of the three strategies wouldn't have.
- To sum up Chapter 1: I like that you've very clearly explained what you did, but some of the other things you've done don't really add anything to the report.
- I like that you give some clear data analysis for how you classified the different series for trading.

- I also appreciate that you show how you decided which parameters to use for each strategy in a data-driven way.
- In summary, Chapter 2 also clearly gives your final decisions, with data-driven justifications being presented along the way, which is good.
- Chapter 3 gives a clear account of how you did out of sample, again reaching to the data where appropriate for justifications.
- I also like your reflections of what went wrong and how you could improve.

Overall, this was a strong report, which clearly described what you did, why you did it, and gave clear data-driven justifications along the way. Your out of sample performance was good, and I think this reflects well on the process that you followed during the project.